Valentin Nikolaev

Senior PHP/Laravel Backend Developer

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Summary

Backend developer with more than 15 years of production experience across PHP and Go, including Laravel systems, APIs and integrations. Combines backend leadership with hands-on architecture, performance improvement and production operations. Recent work includes production event-analytics infrastructure and vendor-neutral services integrating external platforms. Experience spans secure integrations and high-traffic production services.

Skills

Backend: PHP, Laravel, Symfony, Go, REST APIs, microservices, event-driven systems.

Data and infrastructure: MySQL, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, RabbitMQ, AWS, Kubernetes.

Delivery and observability: CI/CD, Prometheus, GitHub Actions, Helm.

Experience

Simple.life (Simple App) — Software Developer — November 2023–2026

- Owned the architecture and backend of a production Amazon Connect calling platform, with security-reviewed privacy and lawful calling controls.
- Built a vendor-neutral Go helpdesk gateway with Intercom and Zendesk adapters, enabling the company's first B2B demonstration of its support AI product.
- Consolidated three Snowflake-to-Intercom pipelines into one engine, eliminating daily full-history reads without downtime or changes to public interfaces.
- Delivered GDPR export automation across seven data sources and reworked account-deletion flows, enabling self-service administration and cancellation handling.
- Implemented support automation and LLM-agent backend scenarios, contributing to a wider platform that reached up to 86% fully automated handling alongside other contributors.

Technologies: Go, PHP, AWS, Intercom, Snowflake, REST APIs.

CRURATED — PHP Software Developer, concurrent part-time consulting — August 2024–January 2026

- Owned production DataLake and event-analytics architecture, increasing DataLake throughput by over 10x while supporting product metrics, reporting and business insights.
- Defined a versioned event schema and owned parallel publication of event versions in production, enforcing consistency across integrations as the event system evolved.
- Owned the production Crutrade integration, connecting accounts and collection transfers with authentication and purchase-ownership verification.

Technologies: PHP, queues, AWS EventBridge, S3, webhooks.

airSlate — Software Developer — February 2021–August 2023

- Led backend performance work that reduced average API response times by approximately 30%, measured with Prometheus.
- Led CI/CD improvements that shortened feature delivery time by 11 minutes, approximately 70%, improving release consistency across services.
- Removed bottlenecks and redistributed main-database workload, improving service stability during high-traffic periods.

Technologies: PHP, Laravel, Symfony, MySQL, Kubernetes, Prometheus, CI/CD.

Hyprr — Technical Lead — November 2019–January 2021

- Led backend development as the product progressed from prototype to closed beta in under six months.
- Defined the technology roadmap with the CTO and helped establish the core stack for product delivery.

Technologies: PHP, Go, Laravel, MySQL, AWS.

Sixt — Senior Software Developer — December 2018–November 2019

PDFfiller.com — Software Developer — October 2016–November 2019

- Led five backend engineers developing a transactional email service handling approximately three million messages in an ordinary month.
- Led the service through Black Friday/Cyber Monday peaks with up to tenfold traffic growth, sustaining capacity and reliability under peak demand.

Technologies: PHP, Laravel, MySQL, RabbitMQ, AWS.

Education

MSc in Computer Science, National Technical University, Kharkiv, Ukraine, 2003–2008.

Languages

Ukrainian — native; English — upper-intermediate.